

■ Question 1: What is a Calculated Field and why is it important in business dashboards?

A **Calculated Field** in Tableau is a custom field created using existing data fields and formulas to derive new insights.

It allows users to perform calculations such as:

- Profit Ratio = Profit / Sales
- Total Revenue = Sales × Quantity
- Profit Category = IF statements

★ Importance in business dashboards:

- Helps create **custom KPIs not available in raw data**
- Enables deeper **business analysis (profitability, growth, efficiency)**
- Reduces dependency on pre-built dataset fields
- Supports **decision-making with derived insights**

👉 Example: Creating **Profit Margin %** to evaluate true product performance instead of just sales.

■ Question 2: Why can't parameters change visuals directly in Tableau?

Parameters in Tableau are **dynamic input values**, but they do not directly control data.

Reason:

- Parameters are **independent values (not linked to data automatically)**
- They do not filter or modify data unless used inside a **calculated field or filter logic**

How they actually work:

- Parameter → Used in Calculation → That calculation affects the visual

👉 Example:

A parameter like "Top N Products" must be used in a calculated field to filter the chart.

Conclusion:

Parameters act as **user inputs**, not direct controllers of visualizations.

■ Question 3: When should EXCLUDE LOD be used?

EXCLUDE LOD (Level of Detail) is used when you want to remove a specific level of detail from a calculation while keeping others.

When to use:

- When you want to calculate a value **excluding a dimension present in the view**
- When analyzing data at a higher level than displayed

Example:

If your view shows:

- Category + Sub-category

And you use:

```
{ EXCLUDE [Sub-Category] : SUM(Sales) }
```

👉 It calculates Sales at **Category level only**

Use case:

- Comparing sub-category performance against category total
 - Creating **variance or contribution analysis**
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❏ Question 4: Difference between FIXED and INCLUDE LOD expressions?**● FIXED LOD**

- Computes values at a **specific level of detail**
- Ignores dimensions in the view (unless filtered in context)

Example:

```
{ FIXED [Region] : SUM(Sales) }
```

👉 Sales is calculated only at Region level

Key point:

- Independent of view structure
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● INCLUDE LOD

- Adds extra detail to the current view level
- Works along with dimensions already in the visualization

Example:

```
{ INCLUDE [Customer] : SUM(Sales) }
```

👉 Adds customer-level detail into current aggregation

Key point:

- Enhances existing view granularity
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⚖️ Key Difference Summary:

Feature	FIXED	INCLUDE
Dependency on view	No	Yes
Level control	Strict (fixed level)	Adds detail
Flexibility	Low	High
Use case	Exact aggregation	Drill-down analysis